

Josip Lukačević

Engineering Manager · Full-Stack Web Developer · 12+ Years Experience

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Zagreb, Croatia (Remote)

PROFILE

Engineering Manager with 12+ years in web engineering — first as a developer, then leading teams, most recently as a startup CTO. I manage by understanding the work, not just the ticket board.

For 5.5 years I ran web engineering at FaZe Clan, one of the world's biggest esports brands — managing the dev and QA teams (hiring, planning, code reviews, delivery) while architecting their platform end-to-end, including an e-commerce operation that processed \$1.6M in a single-day merch drop. Today I'm Co-Founder & CTO of cloaq.ai, an AI-powered photo retouching SaaS.

What I bring:

Team leadership: hiring, sprint planning, code reviews, QA management, on-time delivery

Stakeholder management: single technical point of contact between leadership, creative teams and external partners

Hands-on engineering: Vue.js, Node.js, PHP/Laravel, Shopify, AWS/Cloudflare — I can review a PR, unblock a developer, and challenge an estimate

Remote delivery: 7+ years leading and shipping with distributed teams across US/EU time zones

Founder experience: built and launched an AI SaaS product end-to-end as CTO

AI in production: integrating AI models into real products and using AI tooling daily in my workflow

I learn fast, communicate clearly, and stick around. Average client engagement: years, not weeks. 3,000+ Upwork hours with a 5-star record across every single review.

CORE SKILLS

Frontend: Vue.js, JavaScript (ES6+), jQuery, HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap, Three.js, WebGL

Backend: Node.js, PHP, Laravel, CodeIgniter

CMS & E-commerce: WordPress, Shopify (Liquid templates, Shopify API, Plus migrations)

Databases: MySQL, MongoDB, SQL

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, S3, CloudFront, Route53, Certificate Manager, Load Balancing, IVS), Vercel, Cloudflare, Git

APIs & Integrations: Google APIs (Gmail, Calendar, Drive, Maps, Sheets, YouTube, Contacts), OAuth 2.0, Chrome Extensions, Stripe

AI & Tooling: AI model integrations (image processing & generation), AI-assisted development (daily workflow), Figma, Photoshop, SEO

Leadership: Engineering management, hiring & performance, sprint planning, code reviews, QA management, agile delivery, stakeholder & client communication

EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & CTO *Jul 2025 – Present*

cloaq.ai · Zagreb, Croatia

Co-founding a B2B SaaS app for AI-powered professional photo retouching, targeting fashion and e-commerce studios

Architected a batch processing pipeline reducing per-image time from ~10 minutes to ~10 seconds — 100+ images processed in under 15 minutes

Sole developer across the full stack; own architecture, infrastructure, security and the technical roadmap

Currently in private beta with select partners — launching 2026

Stack: *Vue.js, Laravel, Node.js, PHP, AWS (S3, EC2), Cloudflare, Vercel, AI model APIs*

Full-Stack Developer & Consultant *Jul 2023 – Jun 2025*

Self-Employed · Remote

Delivered full-stack client projects and co-developed an early-stage live video streaming startup (paused to pursue cloaq.ai)

Full-stack development, AWS DevOps pipelines, WordPress sites, and business development support

Stack: *Vue.js, Laravel, PHP, Node.js, WordPress, AWS (S3, EC2, IVS), Cloudflare, Vercel, Git*

Engineering Manager *Jan 2019 – May 2024 (5 yrs 5 mos)*

FaZe Clan · Los Angeles - Remote

Led engineering for one of the world's most recognised esports brands, serving millions of fans globally

Managed a 4-person dev & QA team end-to-end — hiring, sprint planning, code reviews, performance, and on-time delivery across multiple web properties

Architected and built the full platform end-to-end: Shopify e-commerce that processed a \$1.6M single-day merch drop, interactive fan features, and partner integrations

Primary technical contact for internal teams and external partners on all web initiatives

Stack: *Vue.js, Node.js, Shopify, MongoDB, AWS (EC2, S3, CloudFront, Route53, Load Balancing), Bootstrap, Git*

Senior Freelance Web Developer *Apr 2017 – Jan 2019 (2 yrs)*

Upwork · Remote

22 contracts, 100% 5-star reviews, \$80K+ earned, 3,000+ hours logged

Portfolio: e-commerce, SaaS apps, Chrome extensions, interactive 3D maps, WordPress sites, charity platforms

Average engagement: months to years — clients consistently extended due to reliability and delivery quality

Stack: *JavaScript, jQuery, PHP, Laravel, CodeIgniter, Node.js, Three.js, MySQL, MongoDB, WordPress, AWS, HTML/CSS*

Full-Stack Developer *Sep 2017 – Dec 2019 (2 yrs 4 mos)*

Lutify (now fylm.ai) · Tel Aviv - Remote

Sole developer on a browser-based image processing app using 3D LUTs for GPU-accelerated colour grading

Built a WebGL rendering pipeline with Three.js for real-time programmatic colour corrections

Stack: *JavaScript, jQuery, Three.js / WebGL, PHP, MySQL, AWS S3*

Frontend Developer *Feb 2018 – Jan 2019 (1 yr)*

Guidekick · San Francisco - Remote

Built interactive 3D map UIs using the Ambiarc SDK — deployments: Indianapolis Airport (airport tablets), museum kiosk, San Francisco Golden Gate Park

Stack: *JavaScript, jQuery, Ambiarc SDK, HTML/CSS, AWS S3*

Full-Stack Developer *Mar 2017 – Jun 2018 (1 yr 4 mos)*

Tangital · Los Angeles - Remote

Built a Chrome extension and companion website enhancing Gmail functionality on top of the Subtrack platform

Stack: *JavaScript, jQuery, PHP (Laravel), MySQL, AWS EC2*

Web Application Developer *Jan 2015 – Jun 2016 (1 yr 6 mos)*

N-LAB Software · Zagreb, Croatia

Developed N-aos: a web app for managing employee data and working hours for business clients

Stack: *HTML/CSS, jQuery, PHP, MySQL*

Earlier Roles

Clubble — Web Developer (2014–2015)

Zelena Knjizara — Web Developer (2013–2015)

Pako N.G. — Web Developer (2013–2014)

S&T Croatia — Helpdesk Technician (2013)

NOTABLE PROJECTS

cloaq.ai — AI GPU-powered batch photo retouching SaaS for fashion & e-commerce. Reduces processing from 10 min to ~10 sec per image. Launch: 2026.

fyIm.ai — GPU-powered 3D LUT colour grading app in the browser (Three.js / WebGL).

FaZe Clan Web Platform — End-to-end e-commerce and fan platform for a global brand with millions of followers.

Indianapolis Airport 3D Map — Interactive 3D navigation app, live on airport tablets (Guidekick / AmbiarC SDK).

EDUCATION

Artificial Intelligence - Benefits and Risks of AI

[University Algebra Bernays, Zagreb](#) · 2026 · 180 hrs / 6 ECTS
In progress

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology

[Zagreb University of Applied Sciences](#) · 2010 – 2014

CISCO CCNA Certification

[Netacademy ICT Professionals, Zagreb](#) · 2014–2015

Java Programming Course

[Netacademy ICT Professionals, Zagreb](#) · 2015

LANGUAGES

Croatian — Native

English — Fluent